

BlackBerry Protect

BlackBerry Protect is a BlackBerry service that's been around for a while now, and it helps you secure your phone in case you lose it or it gets stolen. Using this service you can track your phone, and even prevent people from using it, to some extent. For example, if someone puts in a new SIM card, and boots up your phone, they will be prompted for your BlackBerry ID password. If they enter it incorrectly 10 times, the phone is wiped. Since the PIN is tied to your ID, you can track the phone if location services are turned on.

Another thing Protect did for phones prior to BlackBerry 10 was take backups of your contact list and BBM contacts regularly, so losing your phone didn't mean you lost all your contact data. With BlackBerry 10, however, this seems to have been discontinued. That's because you can sync your data with BlackBerry Link wirelessly, and don't have to use a USB cable to connect to your PC anymore – more on that later.

If you've lost your phone, you can display a message on the device, asking the person who found it to return it. You can also remotely lock the device, or you can wipe the device (memory card included) remotely, to ensure your data is not accessed.

First things first, you need to enable BlackBerry Protect from your Settings menu on the phone. Once you have done this, you can log on to <https://protect.blackberry.com> and manage your device(s).

